4. AIDS related complex (ARC)

This group includes patients with considerable **immuno deficiency**, suffering from various symptoms or minor opportunistic infections. eg. oral, Candidiasis, salmonellosis or tuberculosis.

5. AIDS

End-stage disease, poor immune defence mechanism leading to the opportunistic infection and malignancies.

a. Commonest symptoms

Drycough, dyspnea and fever. Pheumonia may be viral (cmv) or fungal (Cryptococcus, Histoplasma).

b. Gastrointestinal system

The mouth is often involved with thrush, stomatitis, gingivitis, hairy leukoplakia. Dysphagia due to esophageal Candidiasis. Intestinal pathogen in AIDS is cryptosporidium. Other pathogens are Salmonellae, Mycobacteria, CMV or adeno viruses. 'gay bowel syndrome' is common among the male homosexuals.

c. Central nervous system

The typical CNS opportunistic infections are toxoplasmosis and cryptococcosis. Lymphomas of the CNS are Common.

d. Malignancies

Kaposi's Sarcoma was the lesion seen in male homosexuals. The tumours commonly seen are lymphomas, both the Hodgkin and non Hodgkin types.

e. Cutaneous

Herpes lesions, Candidiasis, Dermatitis, impetigo are common cutaneous lesions.

6. Dementia

Direct **cytopathogenic damage** in the CNS. It cross the blood-brain barrier and cause encepthalopathy leading to dementia.

7. Pediatric AIDS

Viral transmission may occur to the **fetus in pregnancy**. Many of the infected children may not survive for a year. Children may also acquire the infection from blood transfusion or blood products.

Laboratory Diagnosis

Lab diagnosis of HIV infection include tests for immuno deficiency in HIV infection.

A. Immunological tests

i. Total leukocyte and lymphocyte count to demonstrate leucopenia and a lymphocyte count usually below 2000/ mm3.

ii. Platelet count will show thrombocytopenia.

iii. Raised IgG and IgA levels.

B. Specific tests for HIV infection

1. Antigen detection

Single massive infection, as by blood transfusion, the **virus antigens** may be detectable in blood after about two weeks. The major core antigen p24 is the virus marker to appear in blood.

2. Polymerase Chain reaction

It the most **senstitive** and specific test. Two forms of PCR have been used, DNA PCR and RNA PCR.

3. Antibody detection

Demonstration of **antibodies** is the simpest and widely employed technique.

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